

You can clearly see all generated traffic in real-time, and its advanced kernel tuning feature provides protection against broadcasting, spoofing and flooding attacks. It supports both the 2.4 and the 2.6 kernels. Folks running an older version of Linux should get the 0.8.3 version. If a port is opened under “open ports” and closed under “close ports”, what do you think will happen? We have here an exercise for the reader!

8.4.2.2 Bastille-Linux

Referred to as the Bastille Hardening Program, it *locks down* a system and makes it tougher to get compromised. It throws a questionnaire across to the administrator and explains each topic, looking to seek the desired security settings. Later, it forms a system-wide policy and informs the admin about the fissures that have been tightened. Thus it fulfils its main goals by educating the novices and by helping them in making wise choices.

Download the rpm—just over 300 KB—from www.bastille-linux.org/running_bastille_on.htm. As usual, if you’re running an antiquated Linux version, you’ll have to do the homework before getting it to run.

8.4.2.3 Firewall Builder

www.fwbuilder.org/archives/cat_downloads.html gives you this powerful utility. You can choose the Windows- or the Linux-based version. Setting up can take a while and is definitely not for the faint-hearted! The online documentation is pretty good, though, and will see you through.

8.4.3 Heavy-duty firewalls

Having seen the lightweight PC firewalls, it’s time to pay due heed to the 4 x 4s. If you have a medium- to large-scale network, it makes more sense to deploy a common firewall to which the interface to the outside world is defined. For this purpose a handful of devoted open source firewalls, though gigantic in size, are suggested. They generally require a standalone machine but in many cases are satisfied with 386 machines.